RETAIL BANKING · COLLECTIONS AND RECOVERY

Work the right accounts first, and never contact a borrower you must not

A governed collections worklist for the Chief Risk Officer and the Head of Collections

All data is synthetic. The bank, its customers and its staff are invented.

THE ANSWER UP FRONT

One worklist ranks 589 delinquent accounts and holds the ones the rules say to leave alone

INR 44.1

crore

outstanding on 589 delinquent accounts, ranked with the reasons on every row

40

accounts held from contact because the borrower's grievance is still open

2,499

contacts outside 08:00 to 19:00 IST found, 4.0% of all contacts

176 / 177

source files reconciled to what the sender declared, and the short one is flagged

The ask A 6-week pilot in the West and Central collections regions.

Two books spiked this year, and some of the collection pressure breaks the RBI contact rules

WHAT IS HAPPENING

- Microfinance delinquency in Solapur reached 43.6% in May 2026, against about 9% for the rest of the book.
- Commercial vehicle delinquency in Indore reached 26.0% in the same month. By August both had eased, to 17.8% and 16.1%, still about twice the rest of the book.
- Managers build the worklist by hand from several systems, so nobody knows which accounts to work first.
- A file can arrive short and nobody notices. The dialer's June file arrived 37 rows short.

WHY NOW

- The RBI's August 2022 circular on recovery agents forbids contact before 08:00 or after 19:00. The lender answers for its agencies.
- Under the RBI Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021, a borrower can take an unresolved complaint about recovery agents to the Ombudsman.
- Stress raises collection pressure exactly where conduct breaches are most likely.

TODAY AGAINST TOMORROW

From hand-built lists and late surprises to one list rebuilt every time data lands

TODAY

Found after the complaint

- Each manager builds a list from the dialer, the field app, the loan system and the CRM.
- A short or missing file lowers a report, and nobody can see why.
- A conduct breach is found when the borrower complains.
- Every action depends on whoever happens to check it.

TOMORROW

Applied before contact

- One worklist, ranked by a score whose reasons are stored on every row.
- Every file is checked against what the sender declared, on the day it lands.
- Accounts with an open grievance are held, and accounts with conduct flags go to a certified agency.
- Every action needs a named approver, and the bank's controls can refuse it.

HOW IT WORKS

One job runs the whole flow when a month of data lands

01

Lakeflow

18 source feeds and the letters read as they land, checked and reconciled

02

Unity Catalog

row filters and masks on every published table

03

AI in the flow

letters triaged by ai_query; worklist scored and briefed

04

Lakebase

the case queue officers work, with a locked history

05

Genie

three governed agents answer as the signed-in user

06

Databricks App

overview, worklist, case and approvals

07

MLflow judges

a different model family checks the AI output

Lakeflow Jobs starts the cycle when a source system's manifest arrives, and runs every stage in order.

WHAT YOU ARE ABOUT TO SEE

Four stops, each tied to a decision one of you makes

CRO

The overview

Gross NPA, conduct exposure in one number, and whether the data behind it is complete.

HEAD OF COLLECTIONS

The worklist

The accounts to work first, the reasons in words, and the ones on hold.

COLLECTIONS OFFICER

One case

Update the case, propose an allocation, see the control refuse an uncertified agent.

EITHER LEADER

Ask Genie

A plain-language question, answered with only the rows that person may see.

WHAT EACH LEADER GETS

Each leader gets the measures they are already judged on

CHIEF RISK OFFICER

2.95% GNPA

- Down from 3.51% the month before, read from the governed tables.
- Conduct exposure in one number: 2,499 contacts outside the permitted hours.
- Completeness of the data behind every number, file by file.

HEAD OF COLLECTIONS AND RECOVERY

9.1% roll-forward

- The order to work the book, with the score's reasons on every account.
- 40 accounts held for an open grievance; 113 recommended for reassignment to a certified agency.
- Officers' notes and statuses survive every refresh.

THE VALUE CASE

Four value drivers, each with an assumption you can replace

VALUE DRIVER	FROM THE DATA	ASSUMPTION	ILLUSTRATIVE VALUE
Better recovery on the worked book	INR 44.1 crore on the worklist	Cure on the list rises by 1 percentage point	**INR 44 lakh a year**
Fewer conduct breaches	2,499 contacts outside 08:00 to 19:00	The reassignment rule removes half of them	**About 1,250 fewer**
No contact while a grievance is open	40 accounts held today	Each is one less likely Ombudsman escalation	**40 fewer at-risk cases a month**
Analyst time	18 source feeds reconciled by hand	2 analysts for 3 days a month	**6 analyst days a month**

Figures are illustrative. Each assumption is stated so the bank can put in its own number.

WHY YOU CAN TRUST IT

Every number is checked, every person sees only their share, and the AI never decides

COMPLETE DATA

1,045 bad rows kept with a reason

Every planted defect caught with the exact count. 176 of 177 files reconcile.

GOVERNED

Four personas, four answers

The same query, run as each persona. Unity Catalog decides the rows and the masks.

AI EXPLAINS

97% of letters match the recorded ground

Every misconduct letter found. Briefs follow the bank's rules 100% of the time and are judged by another model family.

CONTROLLED

No one approves their own action

An allocation to an uncertified agent is refused before anyone approves it.

One platform, one bundle, one job

Lakeflow
Auto Loader, declarative pipelines, quality rules and quarantine

Unity Catalog
row filters, column masks, tags and the conduct controls as functions

AI Functions and MLflow
ai_query in the pipeline and judges from another model family

Lakebase
Postgres for the case queue and the approvals

Genie
three governed agents with benchmarks

Databricks Apps
runs as the signed-in user

Lakeflow Jobs
one job, started by file arrival

AI/BI dashboards
published without embedded credentials

A BOUNDED PILOT

Six weeks in West and Central, with targets agreed in week one

SCOPE

- West and Central collections.
- 6 weeks.
- Your data, in your workspace.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- Roll-forward rate down by an agreed number of points on worked accounts.
- No contacts outside the RBI hours on worked accounts.
- Every source file reconciled each month.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- Read access to the dialer, field app, loan system and CRM extracts.
- A collections manager for 2 hours a week.
- A named compliance reviewer.

NEXT STEP

Start the pilot on a date you choose

Name a collections manager and a compliance reviewer this week, and we agree the success criteria in week one.